



## The Digital World

A Round-up of Technology News from Across the Globe

## UNITED STATES

A man in the US was arrested for using a GPS tracking device to monitor his ex-girlfriend's movements. This updated a Web site when her car was on the move



## GERMANY

In Koblenz, Germany, a thief returned a laptop he stole from a computer shop. A salesman from the shop, while chasing him, stumbled and broke his arm. The thief apologised and handed the laptop back. He then ran off

## RUSSIA

As part of a British programme to prevent nuclear proliferation, programmers who were once nuclear scientists, are now designing games for the Internet



## UNITED KINGDOM

According to market research firm NOP World, during the first half of this year, 1.9 million Britons went online for the first time in their lives—the highest level of newcomers to the Internet since 2001.



## CHINA

China's online gaming industry is worried that they could lose access to cyber-café, or have games blocked because of problems over licensing, piracy and violence

## SINGAPORE

Singapore has started a campaign, urging children to SMS "Be cool, be bully-free" over their mobiles, hoping that bullies will yield to peer pressure

## AFRICA

US band REM, amongst other musicians, got together on an album released on the Internet, called 'Songs for Sudan', to raise funds for people in the crisis-hit Darfur region of western Sudan



## The Holiday Tech Guide

## Three Incredibly Useful Sites

Travel And Tourism Within India

## indiatourism



[www.indiatourism.com](http://www.indiatourism.com)

This no-nonsense site keeps it simple. You will find everything you need—tours, car rentals, ticketing, etc. It has bundled information about the state as well as the city's history, heritage, etc., so that you don't cluelessly overlook, say, a ruin right in the heart of your destination!

## indtravel



[www.indtravel.com](http://www.indtravel.com)

Notable here is the hotel booking section. Pick a city from the map and the hotels that are located there show up. Choose the hotel that suits your choice and budget. It offers guidance on making your trip memorable. The tips can be insightful as well as amusing.

## eindiatourism



[www.eindiatourism.com](http://www.eindiatourism.com)

This site is peppered with travel guides and tours that take you through wildlife sanctuaries and places of pilgrimage. The India Shopping Guide helps you pick the right kind of souvenirs while on holiday. The Travellers' Tools section has the Airlines Timetable, Distance Calculator, Weather Info, maps of India, a currency converter, and a Railways Timetable.

Windows XP Service Pack 2 allows users to tag a USB flash drive as read-only. This process can be explained by using the search string "Storage Device Policies". The test was to find which of the engines displayed the most relevant results.

All engines did well. The first hit on Google takes you to a page where information is immediately available. The first hit on both MSN and Yahoo! are the same, a link to a site that aggregates syndicated posts from the Web. Some scrolling here takes you to the relevant information.

On to image searches, which is something MSN Search lacks. We chose 'Mandira Bedi' as the search string. Both Google and Yahoo! offer relevant results and both filter images, if you choose.

Google offers a wider range of hits in terms of sources covered. Yahoo's results were somewhat repetitive.

Once again, Google

takes a slight lead in terms of the variety of sources covered, and the variety of pictures offered.

In terms of news coverage, Google News offers Indian content, and is frequently updated, while Yahoo! doesn't have enough India-specific coverage.

Google has a text-only version of this service which is a plus for mobile devices; additionally it lets you

create e-mail alerts based on keywords. Yahoo! offers RSS feeds for its service, a global content similar to Google News, but it had

no Indian content.

Google News offers more content in terms of news items covered under a section than Yahoo! News. MSN Search allows a news search, but does not link to a standalone News section like its rivals—strange, considering that MSNBC is just such a service.

To conclude, Google comes across as a better service, but its rivals are catching up.

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